

M3U Web Picker

Step-by-Step User Guide

v22.1-rc5 - Beginner-first guide with edge cases and troubleshooting

Who this guide is for

Someone who has an IPTV provider and wants a manageable channel lineup and TV guide in Jellyfin, but does not necessarily know or care what M3U, XMLTV, Xstream, canonical event IDs, or EPG reconciliation mean.

RC5 tester note

RC5 advertises `/playlist/channels.m3u` and `/epg/epg.xml` as the public client-facing outputs. Schedule API configuration now uses API-SPORTS only: save one key and let the selected sports build the request plan automatically. The former `/playlist/custom.m3u` and `/epg/combined.xml` routes remain compatibility aliases.

Replay behavior

RC5 fixes the late-night same-game replay problem in API-assisted matching. When replays are disabled, later airings of the same canonical game are suppressed. When replays are enabled, later airings stay attached to the same logical event/channel identity instead of allocating a second sports block.

The whole app in one sentence

Give M3U Web Picker your IPTV source, choose the normal channels you want, optionally describe the sports you care about, and it publishes one playlist plus one TV guide for your media server.

The beginner path

1. Install Docker and Git.
2. Start M3U Web Picker and open the web page.
3. Load one Primary IPTV provider.
4. Pick the normal channels you want to keep.
5. Leave the United States public EPG enabled, or select the countries you actually need.
6. Optionally enable Sports Automation and add sport / league / team selections.
7. Optionally configure the supported Schedule API for stronger sports matching.
8. Run Update Now and wait for the full update to finish.
9. Add the Channels and EPG URLs to Jellyfin.

Guide map - follows the page from top to bottom

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0. Environment Setup

This section gets the application running before you touch IPTV configuration. If you already have the RC5 container running on port 9999, skip to Section 1.

0.1 What you need

- Windows 10/11, macOS, or a modern Linux distribution.
- Docker Desktop on Windows/macOS, or Docker Engine plus the Docker Compose plugin on Linux.

- Git, if you are installing from GitHub.
- A modern web browser.
- An IPTV provider or local M3U file if you want live channels. Sports Automation cannot invent playable streams by itself.
- For schedule assistance, an API-SPORTS account is optional. Provider-derived sports matching still works without it.

You do NOT need a local Python setup

The normal installation runs inside Docker. You do not need to install Flask, SQLite, Python packages, or a web server directly on the host.

0.2 Verify Docker and Git

```
docker --version
docker compose version
git --version
```

If a command says 'not found', install Docker Desktop (Windows/macOS) or Docker Engine + Compose (Linux), and Git, then reopen the terminal. If Docker is installed but cannot connect, start Docker Desktop or the Docker service. On Linux, a permission error may require sudo or adding your user to the Docker group.

```
docker run --rm hello-world
```

The hello-world command should succeed before you continue.

0.3 Fresh install from GitHub

RC5 is on the default repository branch, so no sports-branch clone option is needed.

macOS

```
cd ~/Desktop && git clone https://github.com/zschmook/m3u-web-picker.git && cd m3u-web-picker && mkdir -p backups && docker compose up -d --build
```

Linux

```
cd ~ && git clone https://github.com/zschmook/m3u-web-picker.git && cd m3u-web-picker && mkdir -p backups && docker compose up -d --build
```

Windows PowerShell

```
cd ([Environment]::GetFolderPath("Desktop")); git clone https://github.com/zschmook/m3u-web-picker.git; cd m3u-web-picker; New-Item -ItemType Directory -Force backups | Out-Null; docker compose up -d --build
```

If the folder already exists

git clone will refuse to overwrite an existing m3u-web-picker folder. If that folder is already the correct repository, enter it and run git status first. If it is clean, git pull followed by docker compose up -d --build is the normal update path.

0.4 Open the application

```
http://localhost:9999
```

The normal Compose stack uses host port 9999. Port 10000 is reserved for the separate sports-debug Compose file used during development/testing.

0.5 If port 9999 is already in use

Create or edit a .env file next to docker-compose.yml and choose another host port:

```
M3U_HOST_PORT=10001
```

0.6 localhost, LAN addresses, and Docker networking

- localhost always means 'this machine' from the point of view of the program using the URL.
- If Jellyfin is installed directly on the same host as M3U Web Picker, localhost:9999 is usually fine.
- If Jellyfin is on another computer, use the LAN IP or hostname of the computer running M3U Web Picker, for example <http://192.168.1.50:9999>.
- If Jellyfin itself runs inside another Docker container, localhost refers to the Jellyfin container, not the M3U Web Picker container. The Docker host LAN IP is the safest beginner option; a shared Docker network/service name is an advanced alternative.
- If another device cannot reach port 9999, check the host firewall before changing the application.

Do not port-forward this to the public internet by default

The app manages provider credentials, stream routes, guide configuration, and local automation state. Treat it as a LAN / trusted-network application unless you intentionally add authentication and a secure reverse proxy.

0.7 Persistent state and backups

The normal Compose stack stores live application state in the Docker named volume m3u-picker-data. Rebuilding or force-recreating the container does not normally erase that volume.

Nightly SQLite backups are written to the host backup folder mapped to ./backups by default. The normal Compose file schedules backups at 3:15 AM America/New_York and retains 30 days.

```
M3U_BACKUP_DIR=./backups  
M3U_HOST_PORT=9999
```

Do not confuse container deletion with volume deletion

docker compose down leaves the named volume in place. docker compose down -v deletes the persistent volume and should be treated as a factory reset.

1. Top Bar - Channels, EPG, and Master Update

The top of RC5 exposes the two URLs a media client needs plus the application-wide Master Update controls.

Output	Public path	Notes
Channels	/playlist/channels.m3u	Use this for the M3U tuner/playlist.
EPG	/epg/epg.xml	Use this as the XMLTV guide source.
Compatibility aliases	/playlist/custom.m3u and /epg/combined.xml	Kept for existing clients; new setups should use the public names above.

1.1 Copy buttons and hostnames

The Copy buttons use the host and port you used to open the application. If Jellyfin is on another machine, replace localhost with the M3U Web Picker computer's LAN IP or hostname.

1.2 Master Update

- Automatic update is enabled by default.
- The default time is 3:00 AM in the configured local sports timezone.
- Changing the time changes the next scheduled run.
- Update Now runs the same pipeline immediately.
- A manual Update Now does not move the next normal daily run.
- While running, the UI shows a spinner and elapsed-time counter.
- The last completed cycle records how long it took.

First runs can be slow

Provider parsing and public EPG filtering dominate run time. A multi-minute update is not automatically a failure. Watch the running status instead of repeatedly clicking Update Now.

2. Provider Sources

Provider Sources is where playable channel streams come from. The app supports one Primary source and optional ordered fallback sources for Sports Automation.

2.1 Primary provider - the normal channel catalog

The Primary provider is the only provider catalog shown in Channel Manager. Fallback services do not flood the manual channel list with duplicates.

2.2 Common input formats

What your provider gave you	What to enter
Server/base URL + username + password	Enter the base URL in Provider or M3U URL and use the separate Xstream username/password fields.

One long M3U URL	Paste the full URL. Embedded credentials remain supported.
A local .m3u/.m3u8 file	Use the file control and set it as Primary. This is a static snapshot until you upload a newer file.

Xtream users

Prefer the base/server URL plus separate username and password fields. The app probes `player_api.php`, imports live streams/categories only, and derives the provider guide endpoint internally.

2.3 Loading and replacing a Primary source

- Only one Primary source can exist at a time.
- After a Primary provider is loaded, its credential/input controls are disabled to prevent accidental mutation.
- To change providers or credentials, remove the current Primary first, then add the replacement.
- Manual saved-channel selections are associated with the Primary catalog. Replacing the provider can change what those selections resolve to.

2.4 Very large providers

Safeguard	Default
Maximum provider live channels	50,000
Provider warning threshold	20,000 channels
Maximum provider playlist size	100,663,296 bytes (~96 MiB)
Maximum provider JSON size	100,663,296 bytes (~96 MiB)
Maximum compressed public EPG	268,435,456 bytes (~256 MiB)

The provider limits can be overridden with the `M3U_MAX_PROVIDER_*` variables in `.env.example`. Raising them also raises memory/CPU risk.

Prefer live-only Xtream imports

The app deliberately requests live streams/categories instead of blindly downloading VOD and series catalogs. This matters for providers with very large non-live catalogs.

3. Sports Fallback Providers

Most first-time users should skip this

If you have one IPTV subscription, leave the fallback section empty.

A fallback is not a second manual-channel catalog. It is a sports rescue source. During a sports scan, providers are checked in priority order and a lower-priority provider is used only when a usable higher-priority candidate is missing.

- Fallback channels never appear in the normal Channel Manager catalog.
- A fallback is registered with lightweight validation; full scanning happens during Master Update.
- Use the Use backup feeds option in Sports Automation to allow or disallow fallback feeds.
- A lower-priority provider should not create duplicate sports feeds when the Primary already provides a usable candidate.

4. EPG Output

RC5 has one normal client-facing guide: /epg/epg.xml. Provider guide data, configured guide data, enabled public-country fallback data, and generated sports programmes are reconciled into that one output.

The sports-only XMLTV file is still generated internally for diagnostics and validation, but it is not advertised as a normal Jellyfin/Plex guide source.

4.1 External XMLTV sources

Advanced users can add external XMLTV sources. For ordinary setups, provider guide discovery plus the public-country fallback is usually enough. Avoid adding the exact same guide again directly in Jellyfin; let M3U Web Picker own reconciliation.

5. Free Public EPG - By Country

The public EPG country selector is a general guide fallback, not a sports-only feature.

- United States is enabled by default on a fresh setup.
- Enable only countries you actually need. Unchecked countries are not downloaded.
- The app downloads compressed .xml.gz guides and keeps them compressed on disk.
- Large guides are stream-decompressed and filtered rather than expanded into a giant permanent XML file.
- Provider/configured guide data has higher priority. Public data fills uncovered windows instead of replacing good provider data.
- Public guide data can corroborate sports matching, but it does not override a strong Schedule API + provider match.

Public guide source: <https://iptv-epg.org/guides>

Why not add the giant public guide directly to Jellyfin?

M3U Web Picker filters it down to only the channels/programmes you actually use, so Jellyfin receives one much smaller reconciled guide instead of several overlapping guide sources.

6. Channel Manager

Channel Manager contains manually selected Primary-provider channels plus read-only generated sports channels.

6.1 Manual channels vs generated sports channels

Type	Meaning	Lifecycle
Manual / saved channel	You explicitly selected it from the Primary catalog.	Stays until you remove it.
Generated sports channel	Sports Automation created it for a scheduled/matched event.	Appears/disappears with the event window and automation state.

Hard rule

Sports Automation must never delete, replace, suppress, or hijack a manually saved channel - even if both ultimately point at the same provider stream.

6.2 Search and filtering

- Use search to narrow a large provider list.
- Provider Group filters help when the provider has useful categories.
- Hide SD / low-bandwidth can reduce clutter and also affects sports feed eligibility.
- Manual selections auto-save; there is no separate Save channels button.
- Generated sports rows are read-only. Change Sports Automation rules instead of editing those rows.

6.3 Provider catalog changes

If the provider renames, removes, or reorders channels, saved selections are reapplied against the refreshed Primary catalog. If a selected provider channel disappears entirely, it cannot tune until the provider offers it again or you select a replacement.

7. Manage Order - Manual Channels Only

Manage Order changes only the saved/manual channel order. Sports channels use automation numbering blocks and are not dragged around manually.

Do not make sports numbering behave like manual numbering

Sports channels are transient and remain stable inside their competition blocks for a given event. Manual ordering and sports allocation are separate systems.

8. Sports Automation - Enable / Disable

Sports Automation is optional. If you only want a curated IPTV playlist and one merged guide, leave it off; Sections 0-7 still work.

- Enable sports: generated sports channels participate in the final playlist/guide.
- Disable sports: generated sports rows are hidden from served outputs.
- Your saved sport/league/team rules remain preserved when sports is disabled.

9. Sports Channel Block

Control	What it means	Beginner recommendation
First league block	Base number used for the competition block map.	Leave 1000 unless it conflicts with manual numbering.
Channels per event	Number of numbered slots reserved per event.	Leave the default 10 unless you know you need more feed variants.
Group title	Playlist group/category for generated sports channels.	Use a name obvious in your client.
Timezone	Timezone used to interpret sports dates/times.	Set this to where you actually watch/schedule games.
Event window	Configured sports schedule window.	Use the default unless overnight/timezone boundaries require a broader window.

9.1 Numbering collisions

Sports competitions receive separate 1,000-channel blocks. If manual numbering overlaps the configured sports start, manual channels take precedence and sports allocation moves rather than overwriting them.

9.2 Midnight and long-game edge cases

- Games crossing midnight remain the same logical event; midnight is not a reason to create a second game.
- Generated channels receive a 90-minute postgame grace window so long games and overtime are not removed too early.
- A later rebroadcast is a replay of the original event, not a new game.

10. Schedule API

Schedule API is optional. RC5 uses API-SPORTS only for canonical schedule data. The Schedule API improves event identity and timing for explicitly supported competitions; it is never required for Sports Automation to work.

10.1 What the user configures

The Schedule API UI intentionally has no editable base-URL field. The user turns the feature on and saves one API-SPORTS key. M3U Web Picker owns the sport-product endpoints internally and chooses them from the existing Sports Automation selections.

Provider: API-SPORTS - currently the only supported Schedule API provider. Official site: <https://api-sports.io>

- The stored API key is kept server-side and is not returned to the browser after saving.
- Changing sports selections does not require changing API configuration.
- If the Schedule API switch is off or no key is saved, the existing provider/EPG matcher remains active.

10.2 How selections become API requests

RC5 first builds a request plan from the enabled sports rules. Rules are collapsed into the minimum unique schedule datasets needed for the current event window. Team, conference, and overlapping league rules are then evaluated locally against those datasets.

Example request plan:

MLB + Philadelphia Phillies	-> one MLB schedule dataset
NFL + Philadelphia Eagles	-> one NFL schedule dataset
Big Ten + Penn State + SEC	-> one NCAA schedule dataset
Golf + Track & Field	-> legacy provider/EPG matcher; zero Schedule API calls

The important rule is that API call count scales with unique supported sport/league/date datasets, not with the number of teams, conferences, or overlapping rules selected.

10.3 API-backed sports in RC5

- MLB uses the API-SPORTS Baseball product.
- NFL uses the API-SPORTS American Football product.
- NCAA football uses the same American Football product but a separate NCAA league dataset.
- Big Ten, ACC, SEC, and NCAA team selections are filtered locally from the NCAA schedule. When a conference rule actually needs membership data, that membership is fetched once and cached as longer-lived season reference data rather than fetched once per conference or team. NCAA team-only rules do not require that extra reference call.

10.4 Sports without a supported/free API path

Unsupported sports are expected and are not an error. Golf, track & field, and any other sport without an explicitly implemented API-SPORTS adapter continue through the original provider channel-name + XMLTV matching path. A mixed configuration is normal: MLB/NFL/NCAA can use canonical API schedules while golf or track & field is matched locally during the same scan.

Adding an unsupported sport must not cause an API request, disable the rule, or prevent supported sports from using their API-backed schedules.

10.5 Schedule and reference caching

Normal Master Update and Update Now operations reuse a schedule dataset that has already been fetched for the same local day. Repeated testing therefore does not consume another API request for the same covered dataset/date unless the cache is deliberately bypassed.

- Daily schedule cache: keyed by the API provider/product/endpoint plus normalized request parameters, including league, season/date, and timezone where applicable. Changing those request parameters creates a different cache identity instead of silently reusing the wrong response.

- NCAA conference membership: long-lived season reference data fetched only when a conference rule needs it, then reused for local Big Ten/ACC/SEC filtering.
- Force Schedule Refresh: an explicit advanced control that bypasses the daily schedule cache once; it is separate from the normal Update Now button.
- Quota headers returned by API-SPORTS are recorded with the cached request so the application can report remaining-request information without exposing the API key.

10.6 Failure and stale-cache behavior

The Schedule API is an enhancement, not a single point of failure. If an API request fails, M3U Web Picker leaves existing cached schedule rows intact. A relevant cached canonical schedule can still be used; when no usable canonical schedule exists for an affected sport, that sport falls back to the existing provider/EPG matcher.

This means an API outage, quota problem, missing competition, or unsupported sport should not take the playlist down.

10.7 Canonical event and replay behavior

When an API-backed provider airing matches a canonical game, the API event ID becomes the logical-game identity before provider/XMLTV airing grouping. Later airings of that same game remain the same logical event. With replays disabled they are suppressed; with replays enabled they attach as additional replay programme windows on the same generated channel identity.

Postponed, cancelled, abandoned, or suspended API events are not generated as active sports channels. If canonical data is unavailable, normal legacy timing and replay logic still applies.

11. What Do You Want to Watch?

Sports selections can be broad (sport/league) or specific (team/competitor).

This is where you define sports rules. The picker supports Sport -> League -> Conference -> Team/competitor.

11.1 Broad league rule

```
Baseball -> MLB -> All teams
```

Expected result: one best feed per MLB game unless another explicit rule says you care more about a particular team/event.

11.2 Explicit team rule

```
Baseball -> MLB -> Philadelphia Phillies
```

Expected result: Phillies games may expand into a fuller feed set such as home/away/national/event, while other league games remain one-best-feed.

11.3 League + team together

```
15 MLB games today
MLB selected broadly      -> 1 best feed for ordinary games
Phillies selected explicitly -> expanded Phillies feed set
Same Phillies game        -> one logical event, not two
```

12. Sports Options - Replays, Pregame/Postgame, Backups

12.1 Include replays and encore broadcasts

Off: later airings of the same logical game are suppressed. On: later airings stay tied to the same logical event/channel identity and are represented as additional replay programme windows.

12.2 Include pregame and postgame shows

Off: obvious support content is not selected as the primary game feed. RC5 specifically rejects common betting/odds, preview, recap, studio, pregame/postgame, and similar support rows as the live game candidate in API mode.

12.3 Use backup feeds

When enabled, Sports Automation may use a lower-priority fallback provider only if no usable higher-priority provider candidate can satisfy the event.

13. Generated Sports Channels and Status

Generated rows are temporary automation output. Their assigned channel numbers and logical event identities are intended to remain stable for the same game.

- Broad league rules create one best feed per game.
- Explicit team rules can expand the selected team's game into additional feed roles.
- Team + league overlap merges into one logical event instead of duplicating the game.
- Manual/static channels remain a separate namespace and may coexist with a generated sports feed even when both point to the same underlying stream.
- Finished generated sports channels are pruned after the postgame grace window.

14. What Update Now Actually Does

Update Now runs the same dependency-ordered pipeline as the automatic Master Update.

1. Schedule API refresh (optional)
2. Provider refresh
3. Guide refresh / filtering
4. Sports match / event reconciliation
5. Channel build
6. XMLTV publish
7. M3U publish
8. Validation

Failed updates should not destroy the last good lineup

The update pipeline is designed to publish completed output only after the relevant work succeeds. If a refresh fails, troubleshoot the failed stage rather than repeatedly deleting your persistent state.

15. Connect Jellyfin

Jellyfin needs both the playlist and the XMLTV guide.

```
http://YOUR-SERVER-IP:9999/playlist/channels.m3u
http://YOUR-SERVER-IP:9999/epg/epg.xml
```

15.1 Which address should I use?

- Same machine, non-Docker Jellyfin: localhost:9999 can work.
- Different machine: use the M3U Web Picker host's LAN IP or hostname.
- Jellyfin in another Docker container: localhost points at Jellyfin itself; use the Docker host LAN IP unless you intentionally set up a shared Docker network.

15.2 Keep Jellyfin simple

For this tuner flow, add the M3U Web Picker playlist and the M3U Web Picker EPG. Avoid stacking the same provider/public guides directly in Jellyfin, because M3U Web Picker already performs filtering and reconciliation.

Jellyfin cache can be stubborn

During rapid RC testing, Jellyfin can retain stale tuner/guide mappings. If the served M3U/XMLTV files are correct but Jellyfin is not, removing and re-adding the Live TV sources can clear stale mappings.

16. Other Clients / Plex Notes

The served M3U and XMLTV outputs are standard text formats, but client behavior differs. Validate the exact integration path for the client you use. Plex in particular may have different Live TV discovery/tuner expectations than Jellyfin.

A quick VLC sanity check is useful: open the Channels M3U directly and verify that a selected channel actually plays before blaming guide matching.

17. Updating, Restarting, and Backups

17.1 Normal source update

```
git status
git pull
docker compose up -d --build
```

Use git status first so you know whether local changes could conflict with the pull.

17.2 Restart without rebuilding

```
docker compose restart
```

17.3 Stop and start

```
docker compose down
docker compose up -d
```

The named data volume remains unless you explicitly delete volumes.

17.4 Backup behavior

- The normal stack writes nightly SQLite backups to the host backup folder.
- Default backup time: 3:15 AM America/New_York.
- Default retention: 30 days.
- The default host backup folder is `./backups` unless `M3U_BACKUP_DIR` overrides it.

18. Troubleshooting by Symptom

Symptom	What to check
Primary provider will not load	Recheck URL/credentials. For Xstream use the base/server URL plus separate credentials. Remove the current Primary before changing credentials/source.
No channels in Channel Manager	Confirm the Primary imported live channels and that filters/search are not hiding everything.
Too many sports channels	Check whether a broad league rule overlaps an explicit team rule. RC5 should merge the same game; if it does not, capture event IDs/times and report it.
Wrong support show selected as the game	With Schedule API enabled, obvious betting/pregame/postgame/support content should be rejected as the primary live game. Capture the candidate title/time and canonical game ID.
Midnight replay shows as a new game	RC5 should treat a later same-canonical-game airing as a replay, not a second event. If a duplicate block appears, report it as an RC5 bug.
Guide is missing/stale	Open /epg/epg.xml directly. Confirm provider/configured/public guide inputs updated, then consider Jellyfin cache.
Update takes several minutes	Large provider and public-guide parsing can legitimately take time. Watch the elapsed/status display.
Settings disappear after rebuild	Verify you are using the normal named volume and did not run docker compose down -v.
Backups folder is empty	Confirm the host mapping exists, the container can write to it, and the scheduled backup time has actually passed.
Memory use is excessive	Prefer live-only Xstream imports, avoid unnecessary fallback providers, and do not raise provider size limits just to silence a bad export.

18.1 Inspect the served outputs directly

```
http://YOUR-SERVER-IP:9999/playlist/channels.m3u
http://YOUR-SERVER-IP:9999/epg/epg.xml
```

If those are correct but Jellyfin is wrong, the remaining problem is likely client-side mapping/cache rather than M3U Web Picker output.

How to report a useful sports bug

Include the selected rules, timezone/event window, generated channel name/number, expected game time, whether replays/pregame/backups were enabled, the canonical API event ID when available, and sanitized provider/EPG snippets. Open an issue at <https://github.com/zschmook/m3u-web-picker/issues/new>

19. RC5 Tester Expectations / Known Limits

Area	Expected RC5 behavior	Tester note
Public output names	/playlist/channels.m3u and /epg/epg.xml are the names advertised by the UI.	Old custom.m3u / combined.xml names remain compatibility aliases.
EPG UI	One top EPG link plus the worldwide country selector.	Sports-only XMLTV remains diagnostic, not a normal client-facing guide.
Replay suppression	Canonical API identity suppresses later same-game airings when replays are off.	If a second channel block still appears for the same API game, report it.
Schedule APIs by sport	API-SPORTS adapters plus automatic legacy fallback.	RC5 API-backed schedules cover MLB, NFL, and NCAA football. Other sports keep provider/EPG matching unless a tested adapter is added.
Manual channel isolation	Sports automation cannot hijack a manually saved channel.	Cross-namespace duplicates are allowed.
Sticky top controls	Desktop/tablet keeps the top output/update control area visible while scrolling.	Phone-size layouts fall back to a normal non-sticky header so controls do not consume the viewport.

20. Security and Privacy

- Treat provider credentials, API keys, the Docker data volume, backup databases, and raw provider M3U files as secrets.
- The UI hides stored provider credentials after save; that does not mean the local configuration is encrypted.
- Do not expose port 9999 directly to the public internet unless you add an appropriate security layer.
- Generated sports IDs are credential-free, but underlying playback still ultimately reaches provider streams.
- When asking for help, prefer screenshots of UI/status plus sanitized M3U/EPG excerpts rather than raw credential-bearing files.

Sanitize logs before sharing

Search logs and snippets for http, user, pass, token, key, and x-apisports-key. Replace secret values or credential-bearing URLs with [REDACTED] before posting them.

21. Glossary - enough IPTV vocabulary to use the app

Term	Plain-English meaning
M3U	A text playlist describing channels and the URLs used to play them.
EPG	Electronic Program Guide - the schedule/listings shown in a TV client.
XMLTV	A common XML format used to deliver EPG data.
Xtream	A common IPTV provider API/login style using a server URL, username, and password.
Primary provider	The provider catalog used for manual channel selection and first-priority sports matching.
Fallback provider	An optional lower-priority sports-only rescue source.
Canonical event ID	A stable schedule identifier used to recognize that multiple provider airings refer to the same game.
Logical event	The app's representation of one real game, independent of how many provider rows or airings mention it.
Feed role	Home, away, national, event, or similar role attached to a generated sports channel.
Replay / encore	A later airing of the same real game.
Programme window	The start/stop interval attached to an XMLTV programme entry.
Master Update	The single application-wide refresh cycle that updates schedules, providers, guides, sports, playlist, and validation.

22. Final Setup Checklist

- M3U Web Picker opens on the expected host/port.
- One Primary provider is loaded and its status looks healthy.
- Only the manual channels you want are selected.
- Free Public EPG countries are limited to the countries you actually need.
- Sports Automation rules are correct, if sports is enabled.
- Schedule API is either configured with an API-SPORTS key or intentionally disabled; unsupported sports still use legacy matching.
- Update Now completes successfully and the elapsed/status result looks reasonable.
- Jellyfin has the M3U Web Picker Channels URL plus the M3U Web Picker EPG URL for this tuner flow.
- A manual channel tunes and has guide data.
- A generated sports channel, if enabled, tunes and has the expected guide event.
- You know where backups are stored and have not exposed the management port publicly.

Done means done

If your selected channels and generated sports feeds appear in Jellyfin with sane guide data, stop configuring things. The advanced knobs exist for edge cases; they are not a checklist of features every user needs to turn on.

Useful Links

Project: <https://github.com/zschmook/m3u-web-picker>

Report a bug: <https://github.com/zschmook/m3u-web-picker/issues/new>

Docker Desktop: <https://www.docker.com/products/docker-desktop/>

Git downloads: <https://git-scm.com/downloads>

API-SPORTS: <https://api-sports.io>

Public EPG guide list: <https://iptv-epg.org/guides>

Appendix A. UI Reference Screenshots

Screenshots were added back into this guide for visual reference. Some images are representative UI examples captured from earlier guide work, so exact wording or control placement may vary slightly by build, but they remain useful for understanding the major sections of the application.

Current top controls

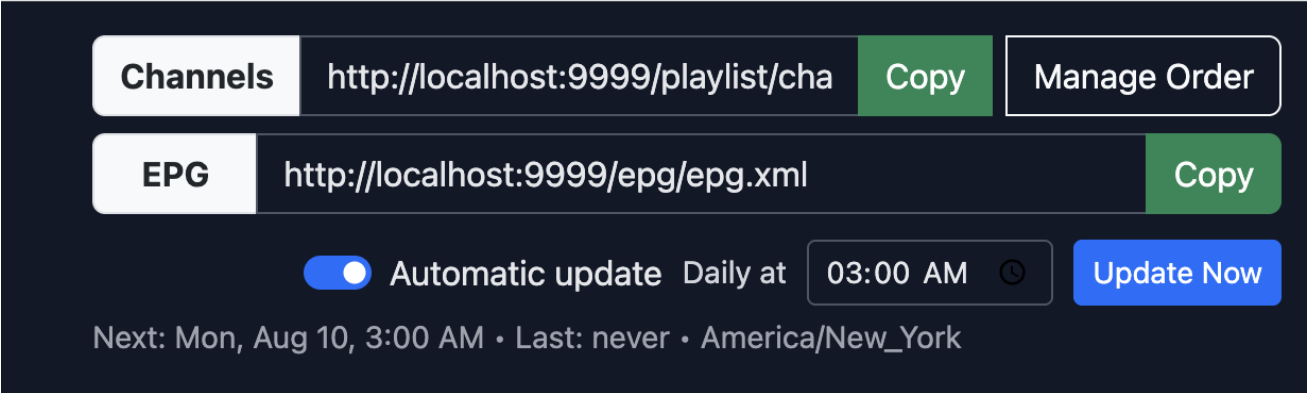


Figure A.1. Current top controls

Provider Sources

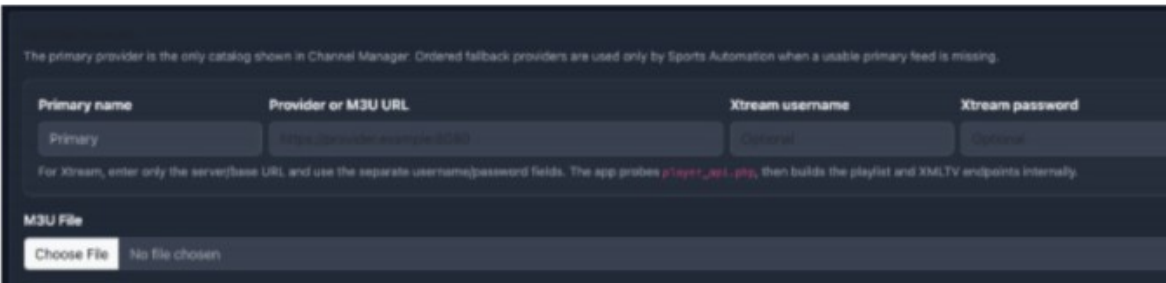


Figure A.2. Provider Sources

Sports Fallback Providers

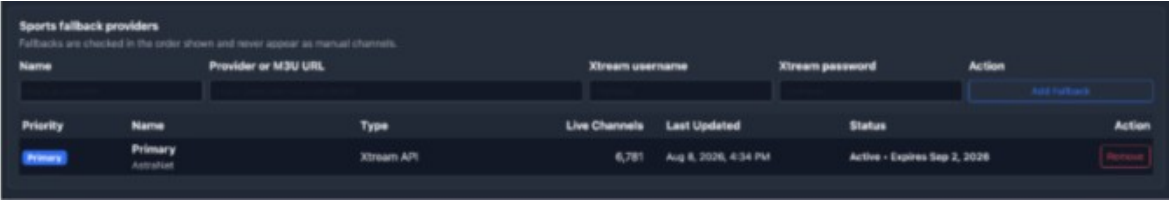


Figure A.3. Sports Fallback Providers

Free Public EPG by Country

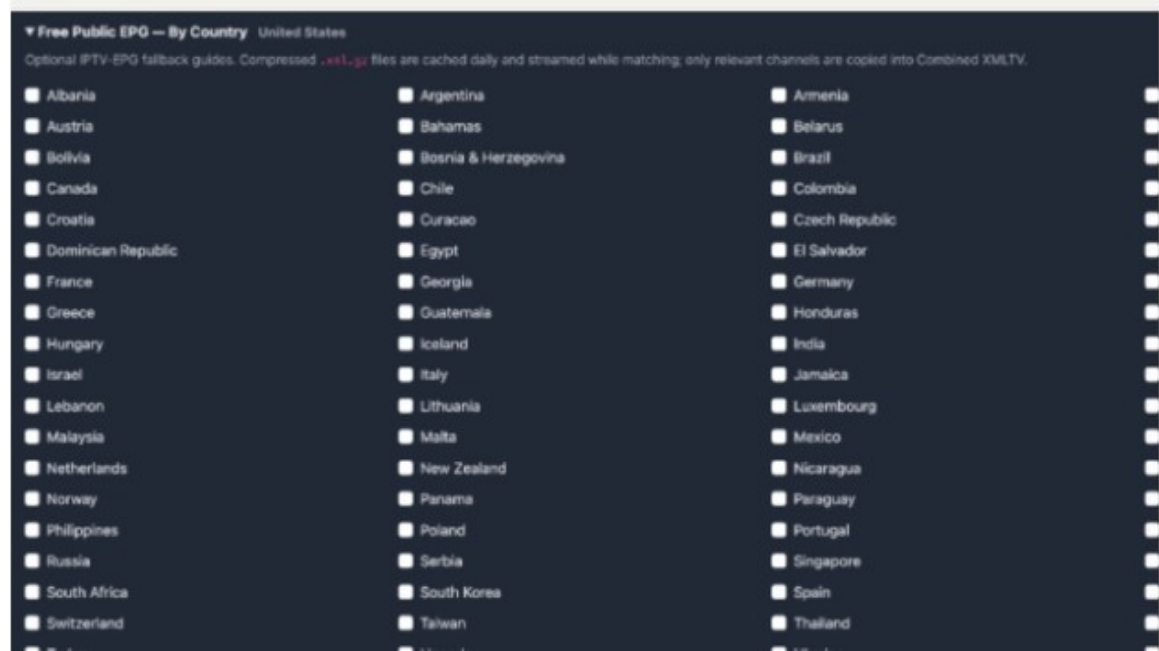


Figure A.4. Free Public EPG by Country

Channel Manager

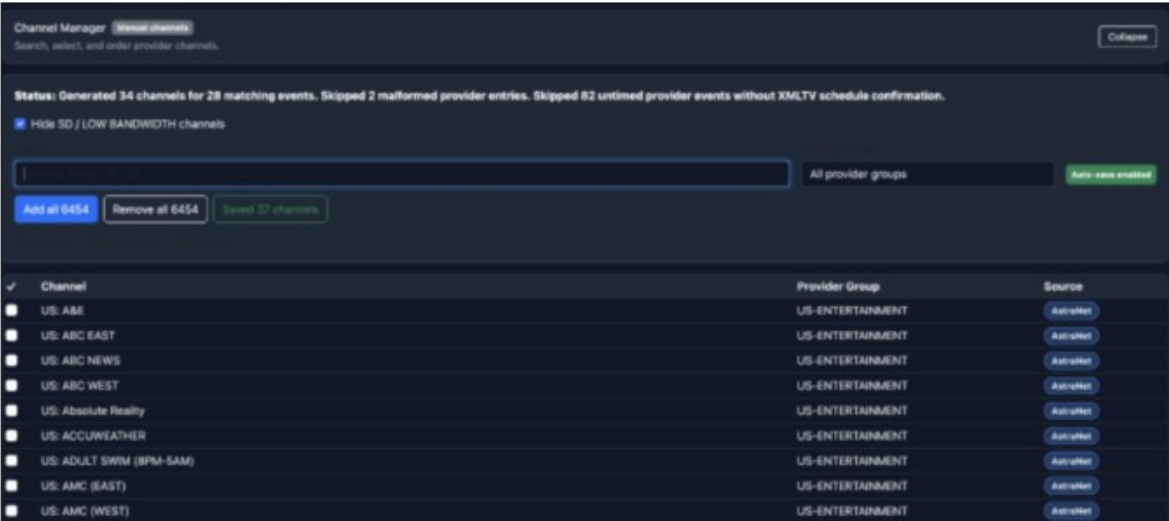


Figure A.5. Channel Manager

Manage Order

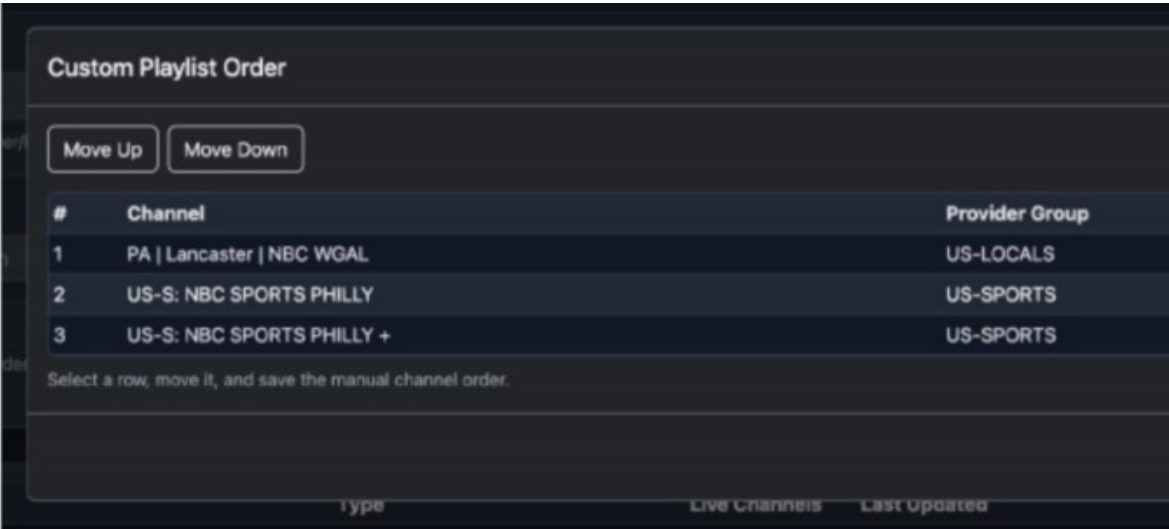


Figure A.6. Manage Order

Schedule API

1. Schedule API

Sports Automation

Enabled

2 selections - 34 generated channels

Sports channel block

Generated channels stay separate from normal channel numbering.

First league block

Channels per event

Group title

1000

10

Sports Today

Timezone

Event window

America/New_York

Current sports day

Each league/series gets 1,000 channels: 100 event slots at 10 channels per event. Overflow uses a separate continuation block.

▶ View league / series channel blocks

Schedule API

Optional canonical schedule data. Leave this off to use the existing provider-derived matching.

API URL

API key

API key copied

Schedule API enabled but not fully configured - enter the API URL and key, then save.

Loaded schedule APIs

API	Scope	URL	Status	Last Update
API-BASEBALL	MLB	—	Incomplete	—

The master application update runs in dependency order: schedule cache → provider/channel refresh → guide refresh → sports match/build → M3U/XMLTV publish.

Figure A.7. Schedule API

What Do You Want to Watch?

What do you want to watch?

+ Add sports selection

Choose broad sports or drill into leagues, series, tours, promotions, conferences, and teams.

Team

Philadelphia Phillies

MLS team • Home and away games

League

MLB

Every Major League Baseball game

☐ Include replays and encore broadcasts

☐ Include pregame and postgame shows

Generated sports channels

The Channel Manager above updates after each successful scan.

1000

MLB • Los Angeles Dodgers at Arizona Diamondbacks — Event Feed

Provider event stream • 3:00 PM

1010

MLB • Atlanta Braves at New York Yankees — Yankees Feed

Home broadcast • New York Yankees • 3:05 PM

1020

MLB • Atlanta Braves at New York Yankees — Event Feed

Provider event stream • 4:00 PM

1030

MLB • Los Angeles Angels at Miami Marlins — Marlins Feed

Home broadcast • Miami Marlins • 4:10 PM

Figure A.8. What Do You Want to Watch?

Legacy EPG manager reference

EPG Manager

Built-in and external XMLTV guides served by this application. Shared provider URLs and credentials are hidden after saving.

NAME	TYPE	SERVED URL	STATUS	ACTION
	External			Add
Combined	Built-in	http://localhost:10000/epg/combined.xml	COPY Updated Aug 8, 2025, 4:41 PM 212 KB	Managed
Sports	Built-in	http://localhost:10000/epg/sports.xml	COPY Updated Aug 8, 2025, 4:41 PM 64 KB	Managed
No additional XMLTV sources.				

Figure A.9. Legacy EPG manager reference